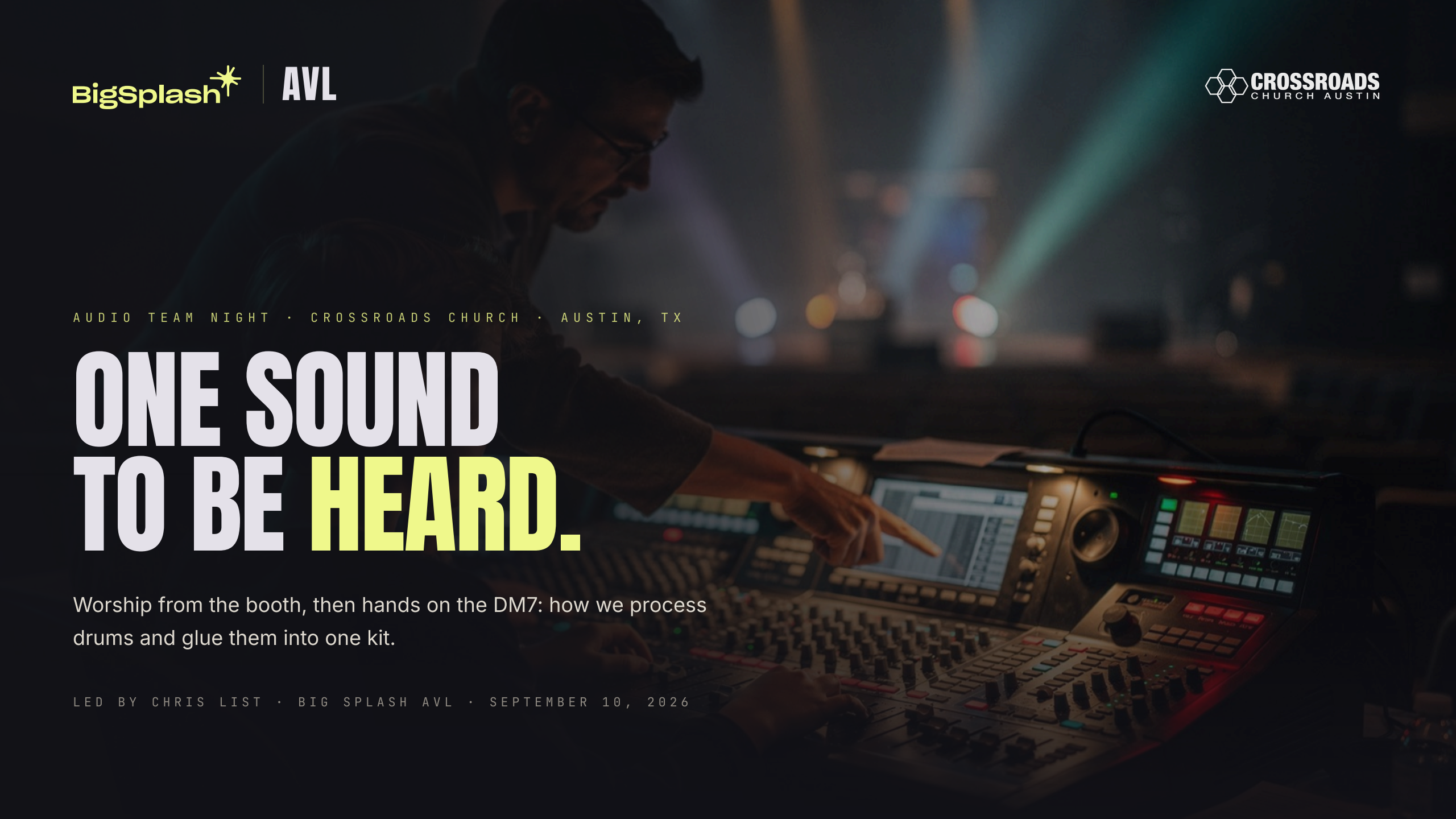
BigSplash | AVL

CROSSROADS CHURCH AUSTIN



AUDIO TEAM NIGHT · CROSSROADS CHURCH · AUSTIN, TX

ONE SOUND TO BE HEARD.

Worship from the booth, then hands on the DM7: how we process drums and glue them into one kit.

LED BY CHRIS LIST · BIG SPLASH AVL · SEPTEMBER 10, 2026

TONIGHT · 40 TO 45 MINUTES

HEART FIRST. THEN HANDS.

00

WELCOME + PRAYER

3 MIN

Open the night by inviting God into the room.

01

THE WORD: ONE SOUND

8 MIN

2 Chronicles 5. Craft as offering, the booth on the team, hearts ready first.

02

DRUMS: THE CHANNEL

15 MIN

Setup order and starting points for every drum on the DM7.

03

DRUMS: THE GROUP

10 MIN

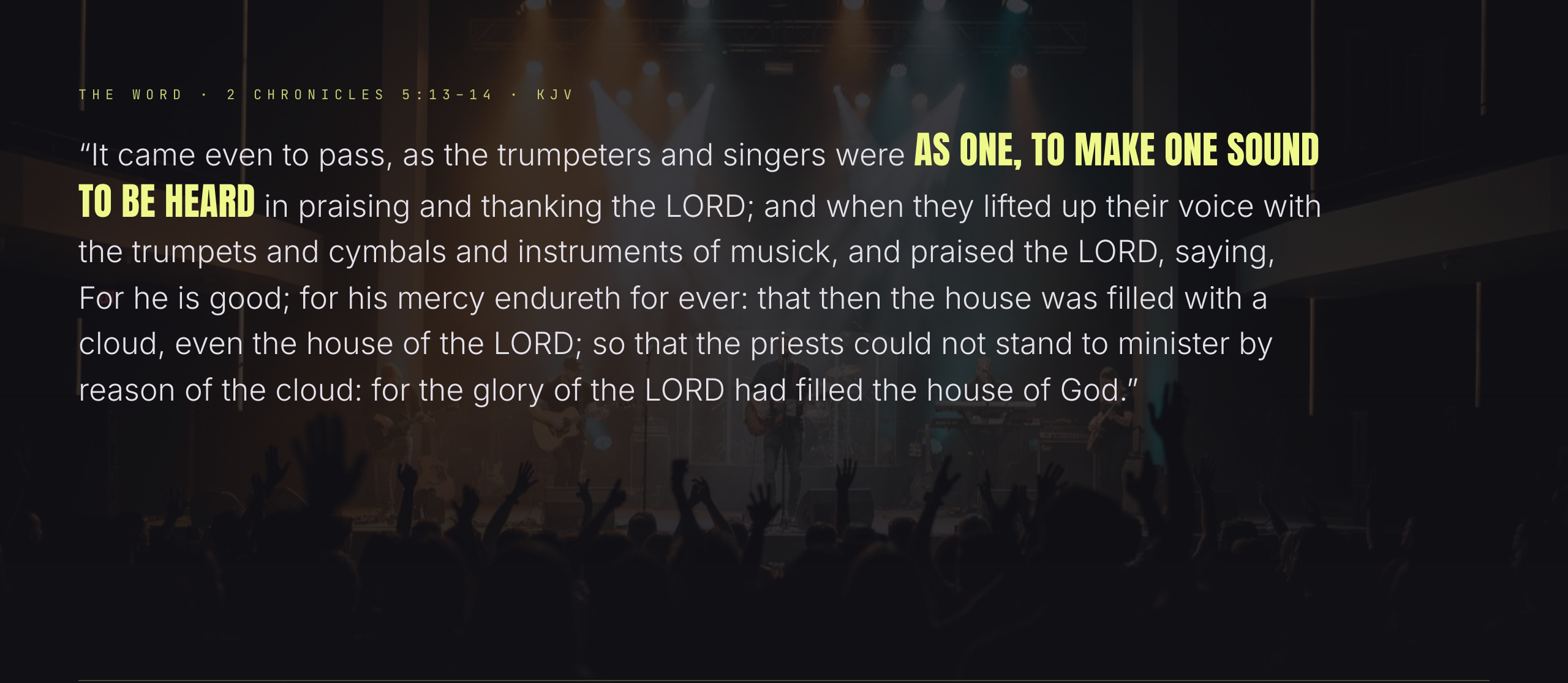
DCA versus group bus, routing, and glue. Build the kit on the multitrack.

04

YOUR QUESTIONS

10+ MIN

Open floor. Starter questions on the last page.



THE WORD · 2 CHRONICLES 5:13-14 · KJV

"It came even to pass, as the trumpeters and singers were **AS ONE, TO MAKE ONE SOUND TO BE HEARD** in praising and thanking the LORD; and when they lifted up their voice with the trumpets and cymbals and instruments of musick, and praised the LORD, saying, For he is good; for his mercy endureth for ever: that then the house was filled with a cloud, even the house of the LORD; so that the priests could not stand to minister by reason of the cloud: for the glory of the LORD had filled the house of God."

SET THE SCENE
≈ 1 MIN

Solomon dedicates the temple. Before a note is played, every priest has sanctified himself, and nobody waits for his shift (v.11). Levites in white linen hold cymbals, psalteries and harps, with 120 priests on trumpets (v.12). The sound goes up as one, and God fills the house so thick the priests can't stand.

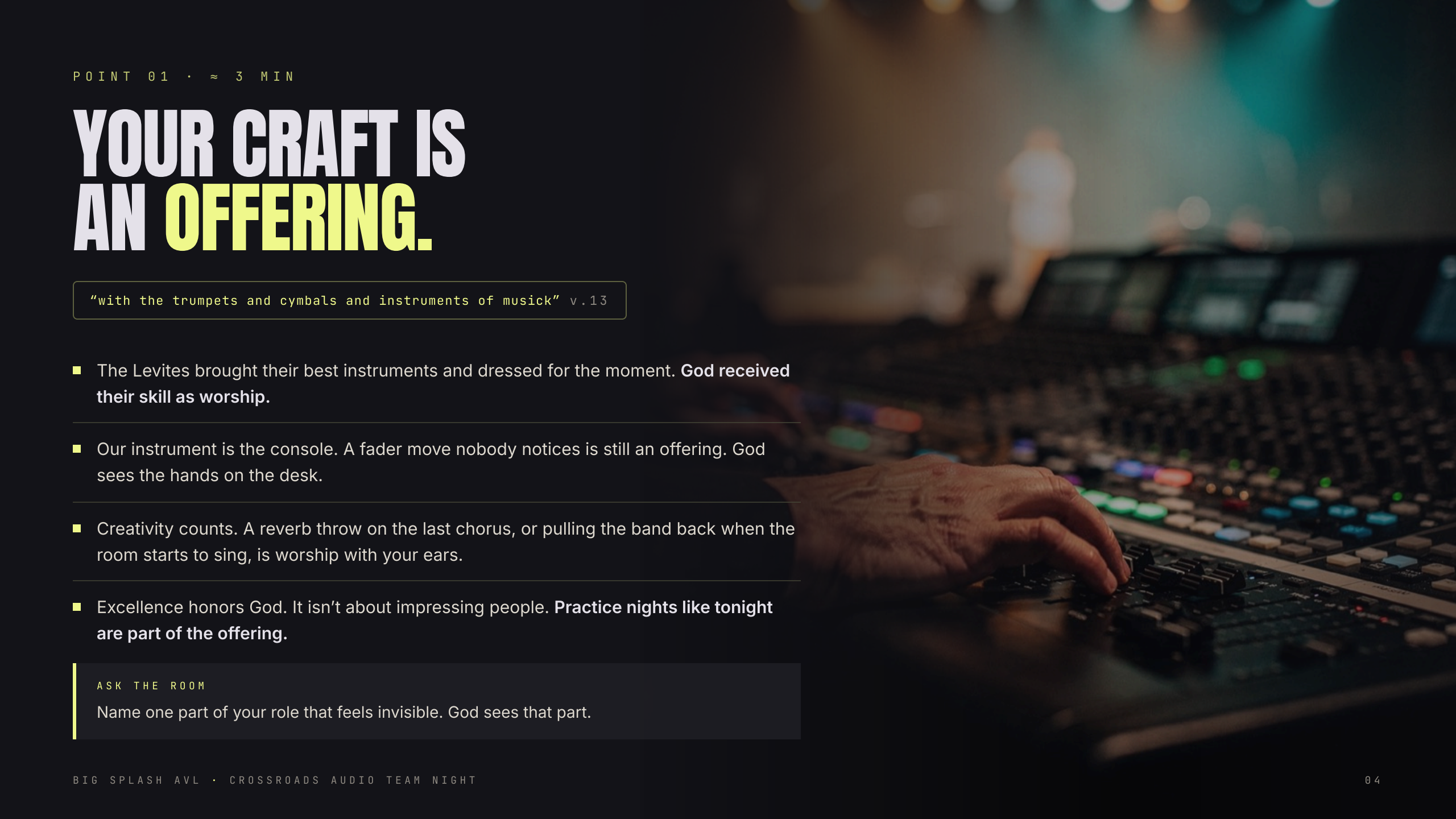
POINT 01 · ≈ 3 MIN

YOUR CRAFT IS AN OFFERING.

> “with the trumpets and cymbals and instruments of musick” v.13

- The Levites brought their best instruments and dressed for the moment. **God received their skill as worship.**
- Our instrument is the console. A fader move nobody notices is still an offering. God sees the hands on the desk.
- Creativity counts. A reverb throw on the last chorus, or pulling the band back when the room starts to sing, is worship with your ears.
- Excellence honors God. It isn’t about impressing people. **Practice nights like tonight are part of the offering.**

> ASK THE ROOM
>
> Name one part of your role that feels invisible. God sees that part.



POINT 02 · ≈ 3 MIN

THE BOOTH IS ON THE WORSHIP TEAM.

"as one, to make one sound to be heard" v.13

- The singers couldn't make one sound alone. Voices and instruments had to arrive together. **Making one sound heard is the booth's job description.**
- You are as much a part of the worship team as the person holding the mic. The room hears the band through your hands.
- Nobody waited for their shift (v.11). FOH, monitors, lyrics, lights and stream serve as one team.
- Unity looks like early call times, serving the song over our taste, honoring the band in how we talk to them, and owning mistakes fast.

> SAY IT PLAINLY
>
> If the room worships, the booth worshiped too.



THE RESPONSE · ≈ 2 MIN

CONSECRATED FIRST.

> “all the priests that were present were sanctified” v.11

The priests got their hearts ready before the music started. The glory came to a prepared people, not a perfect soundcheck. **A line check matters. A heart check matters more.**

TOGETHER · WEEKLY

The team prays together every week we serve. Sunday call time, before line check.

ON YOUR OWN · ALL WEEK

Time in the Word and in prayer. You can’t give the room what you haven’t received.

CLOSE IN PRAYER

Pray over the team: for one sound, and for hearts that stay close to Him. “For he is good; for his mercy endureth for ever.”



HANDS ON · DRUMS ON THE DM7 · ≈ 15 MIN

EVERY DRUM. SAME ORDER.

Build every drum channel in this order, every time. On the DM7 we run the gate in **Dynamics 1** and the compressor in **Dynamics 2**.

01
GAIN
HEAD AMP

Set it on the loudest song. Hits land with headroom to spare. Faders fix balance, not gain.

→

02
HPF
HIGH-PASS FILTER

Cut the low end the drum doesn't make. Clears mud and stage rumble before it stacks up.

→

03
POLARITY
Ø BUTTON

Flip snare bottom. Check kick in against kick out, and overheads against the snare. Keep the fatter one.

→

04
GATE
DYNAMICS 1

Toms first. Kick only if it's messy. Never on hi-hat or overheads.

→

05
EQ
4-BAND PEQ

Cut before you boost. Sweep a narrow boost to find the ugly frequency, then pull it down.

→

06
COMP
DYNAMICS 2

Control, not squash. A slower attack lets the stick through. Then route to the drum group.

GET CLOSE. LET THE ROOM DECIDE.

KNOW THE MIC FIRST

A scooped kick mic like the Audix D6 already cuts about 8 dB at 600 Hz. Cut it again and the kick goes hollow.

DRUM	HPF	GATE · DYN 1	EQ MOVES	COMP · DYN 2
KICK	30-40 Hz	Optional. Fast attack, decay 150–250 ms	Weight 50–70 Hz · cut box 300–600 Hz · click 3–5 kHz	4:1 · 10-30 ms · 3-6 dB
SNARE TOP	80-100 Hz	Only if hi-hat bleed keeps opening it	Body 150–250 Hz · cut ring 400 Hz–1 kHz · crack 4–6 kHz	4:1 · 5-15 ms · 3-5 dB
SNARE BTM	150-200 Hz	No	Polarity flipped · pull low mids · blend in for rattle	Light or off
TOMS	60-80 Hz floor 50-60	Yes. Hold and decay follow the note	Cut mud 300–500 Hz · attack 3–5 kHz	3:1 · 2-4 dB
HI-HAT	250-400 Hz	No	Tame clang near 1 kHz · leave the top alone	Off
OVERHEADS	150-300 Hz	No	Tame harsh 2–4 kHz · air shelf above 10 kHz	Light, if any

COMP COLUMN: RATIO · ATTACK · GAIN REDUCTION ON THE LOUDEST HITS

ONE KIT. ONE FADER.

DCA · REMOTE CONTROL

RIDES THE KIT

Moves the drum faders together. No audio passes through a DCA, so you can't compress it. Use it to ride the whole kit through a song.

GROUP BUS · THE GLUE

SHAPES THE KIT

A mix bus every drum flows through. One place to compress and EQ the whole kit so it hits like one instrument.

GLUE SETTINGS

RATIO	2:1 to 4:1
ATTACK	10–30 ms
RELEASE	Fast or auto
REDUCTION	2–3 dB

Group EQ stays gentle: a touch at 60–100 Hz, a touch of air near 10 kHz.

ROUTING ON THE DM7

DRUM CHANNELS → DRUM GROUP BUS → STEREO

Turn the drum channels' direct send to Stereo off. Send them both ways and the kit doubles up and jumps in level every time you touch the group.

LEVEL UP · PARALLEL SMASH

Send the kit to a second bus and crush it: 8:1 or more, fast attack, 8–12 dB of reduction. Tuck it under the group for big choruses.

BUILD THE KIT FROM THE GROUND UP.

01 **Faders down.** Drum group fader at unity.

02 **Kick alone.** Gain, HPF, EQ, comp. Then take it out of solo.

03 **Snare top and bottom.** Flip the bottom and keep the fatter setting.

04 **Overheads.** The picture of the kit. Check them against the snare.

05 **Toms.** Gate them so fills sound full with no ring between hits.

06 **Hi-hat.** Bring it up until you hear the time, then stop.

07 **Group.** Two to three dB of glue, then ride the DCA against the band.

LISTEN FOR

Kick and bass lock into one note. The snare cuts through without fighting the vocal.

Cymbals sit behind the vocal, never on top. Solo to fix, un-solo to judge.

OPEN FLOOR · 10 MINUTES OR MORE

YOUR QUESTIONS.

IF THE ROOM GOES QUIET, START HERE

- Gate or no gate: which drums get one, and why?
- My snare sounds great soloed and disappears in the mix. Fix?
- Drums in a worship mix: how loud is right for our room?
- The drummer swapped the snare Sunday morning. Now what?

THIS WEEK

Pray together at call time. Meet with God before you meet the console.

chris@bigsplash.agency